



The Midnight Sky trailer released

Directed by and starring George Clooney, the film is set to hit Netflix on 23 December. <http://digit.in/nov20-81>



The Son greenlit by HBO

An adaptation of Jo Nesbø's novel - The Son, starring Jake Gyllenhaal has been greenlit by HBO. <http://digit.in/nov20-82>

Consistency over clarity

Google Workspace icons get a makeover by kindergarteners

Boo-Man | boo@digit.in

They say the only constant in life is change. Such poetry, such truth ... such a massive pile of bullshit. Now before you go about screeching because I've disparaged your life mantra, hear me out. I too believe in this little golden snippet of wisdom since I've grown from a young strapping lad into an even younger and wiser old man. And don't even get me started on how my body has changed. Every week, it's a different part of the body that starts hurting. It's just that, sometimes I find these changes to be unnecessary or forced. Just because you have to stick to a silly mantra doesn't mean that you should forcibly change things that work, you shouldn't change things for the sake of change. That's just moronic and Google is the latest to join that club.

The young 'uns at Mountain View recently undertook a little branding exercise for G Suite, the enterprise version of their productivity suite which includes Google Docs, Spreadsheets, Gmail and all the other apps. Renamed as Google Workspace, they've certainly made it obvious and clearer as to what the platform is all about but they did a nasty U-turn with the iconography. I've put the new icons above for your viewing pleasure. I'll wait till you're done throwing up.

The old G Suite icons were easily distinguishable. You know that the

envelope icon meant that it was a mail service and quickly equated that to Gmail. The same could be said about Calendar, Google Docs was a sheet of paper and Google Meet was a webcam within a chat bubble. Each icon got the message across clearly and established its purpose without a shadow of doubt. Now the new icons all sport Google's colours but for the sake of consistency, they've sacrificed clarity. The icons for Calendar, Google Docs and Google Meet appear to be the same. The exact same colours, same



rectangular design, just the order of colours have been moved about along with the red-coloured dog-ear on one of the corners. It's like the designer put off the logo redesign until the eleventh hour and put together some sort of garbage.

OR

The designer had a really awesome vision and put that forth along with several other designs simply because they had to give Google options and the nice executives over at Google chose the crappiest design from the entire lot. Either ways, someone needs to go flying out of a window for this atrocious change. One could imagine the designer dreaming of having an Apple-esque all-white presentation such as what Jony Ive used to have with each new Apple product launch. Only to have some brain dead execs ruin it all by

picking the logos that had the "company colours".

A logo is supposed to embody the spirit of the company, have the proper message about what it is meant for, be simple in design, stand out from the rest and have the right colours. It takes a special kind of talent and extremely special thought process to pick the option which avoids checking all the boxes by a mile. If you were to give the Google execs that picked these ghastly new logos a colouring book, they'd dip it in buckets of red, yellow, blue and green and marvel at the monstrous outcome. Gmail's red has been a constant for decades and the same can be said for the blue that Google does

and Calendar had. Green has been consistent with their messaging and communication apps that have come and gone over the years. Google Duo is an exception and we all know that's going to be dead soon since Google Meet does everything that Duo can and does it better.

I'd like to end my insanely long rant with an apology. *SHOCK* There is a possibility that these new icons were picked by a colour blind person and if that's the case, I humbly apologise. The needs of colourblind folks must be kept in mind when picking colours for such projects but if that's not the case then this is the most ... then someone should seriously be shown the door. You'd think that the folks over at Google would be proficient at using their own search engine to figure out simple principles of iconography but you'd be surprised. I sure was. 